PRIMECREST.

NOVEMBER 2026 · VOL. XIII · NO. 13 WHERE VISION MEETS VOICE

COVER STORY

Journeys Meet Opportunity:

Navigating Life Across Borders

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The flight she did not board
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Gratitude, humility, and the people who helped.

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Every stamp, 1990 to 2026
Izhevsk to Makkah to Chongqing, in ink.

DEMO

BEYOND BORDERS · IN HER words · FOUNDER · WORLDZEN

BERKUT · THE GOLDEN EAGLE · IZHEVSK, 1990

FOUNDER · WORLDZEN

From a girl in Izhevsk to the founder of an international company without borders.

LIUTCIIA Berkutova

THEPRIMECREST.COM



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DEMO

MASTHEAD · DATA PAGE

Credits.



TYPE / ISSUE
The November Issue · Vol. XIII

SURNAME
Berkutova

GIVEN NAME
Liutciia

BORN
1990 · Izhevsk, Udmurtia

OCCUPATION
Founder, WorldZen

DATE OF ISSUE
November 2026

DEMO

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P<PCXIII<BERKUTOVA<<LIUTCIIA<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<
WORLDZEN<<NOV2026<<FORTIORA<GROUP<LLC<<<<<<13

Born with the name of an eagle.

> I could have passed along a phone number. Instead, I organized an event.
>
> LIUTCIIA BERKUTOVA, ON THE DESERT OUTING THAT BECAME GULFDZEN

In July 2020 the Russian Embassy announced an evacuation flight out of Saudi Arabia. Liutciia Berkutova had a way home. She did not board. Twenty people had come to the first desert gathering she organized around a local pilot's small aircraft, and the business that grew out of it, GulfDzen, had added desert picnics, barbecues and transport for groups. She stayed at her own risk and kept building.

That decision is the hinge of the essay that follows. It is not the whole of it. She was born in Izhevsk in 1990, a year before the Soviet Union ceased to exist, and grew up there. She worked a year as an economist. Then a season with Coral Travel in Phuket, then about a year and a half as a croupier in Cyprus. February 2022 brought serious investment losses, and she stopped operating GulfDzen. In October 2024 she was back in the Kingdom on a business visa, working the opening of Sindalah.

This year she reached Makkah on June 12, the anniversary of her hometown's founding. Then came WorldZen, which helps people with visas, relocation and international travel. She registered it in Russky Vozhoy, the Udmurt village she moved to after returning from Saudi Arabia.

We asked her to tell it herself. She wrote it year by year, and we have printed it that way, from page six, under her own headings and in her own order. Her surname comes from berkut, the Russian name for the golden eagle. She mentions it once.

1990
BORN IN IZHEVSK, UDMURTIA

2008
FIRST WORK IN TOURISM, WHILE STUDYING

July 2020
THE EVACUATION FLIGHT SHE LET LEAVE

2026
WORLDZEN, REGISTERED IN RUSSKY VOZHOY

DEMO



 Gold leaf across the eyes. Liutciia Berkutova, Founder of WorldZen.

From a girl in Izhevsk to the founder of an international company without borders

Eighteen years. A world of reinvention. One belief: freedom begins with an idea in your mind.

BY LIUTCIIA BERKUTOVA —— FOUNDER OF WORLDZEN

DEMO

I once missed an evacuation flight on purpose. I built an aviation-adventure business while stranded in Saudi Arabia, lost it, and began again. But the most unlikely part of my story is not what happened in the desert. It is where the journey began: Izhevsk, in Russia.

○ 1990

IZHEVSK · UDMURTIA

The Girl Who Believed in Miracles

I was born in 1990 in Izhevsk, the capital of Udmurtia, Russia, in the final years of the Soviet Union. Izhevsk – city known worldwide for its connection to Mikhail Kalashnikov, the designer of the AK-47. A year later, the Soviet Union would cease to exist. In the Chinese zodiac, 1990 was the Year of the Metal Horse. Looking back, I like its symbolism: movement, independence, and the determination to keep going.

Izhevsk is known as Russia's arms capital, yet it still has no major international airport. I grew up in Izhevsk. International capitals and distant oceans seemed like places from another universe.

I did not grow up with influential connections or an inherited business. What I had was curiosity. Even as a girl, I sensed that the world was much larger than the one immediately around me. I wanted to know how other people lived, what opportunities existed beyond familiar borders, and whether the place where you were born really had to determine your future.



I was born with the name of an eagle, and I grew up determined to find my own wings.

My nationality is Tatar. My surname, Berkutova, carries a symbolism that feels almost destined. “Berkut” is the Russian name for the golden eagle — one of the world’s largest and most powerful birds of prey, known for its strength, extraordinary vision, and ability to soar high above the mountains. To me, the golden eagle represents freedom, courage, and independence. Perhaps it is no coincidence that I have spent my life refusing to let borders define how far I can go. I was born with the name of an eagle, and I grew up determined to find my own wings.

◦ 2008 My First Passport to Possibility

My first professional experiences in tourism began in 2008, while I was studying. I learned about package holidays and booking systems, helped my family arrange international passports, and began organizing trips.

One of my proudest early experiences was organizing my sister's wedding in Sri Lanka. It wasn't simply a destination celebration. For me, it was proof that a young woman from Udmurtia could turn a distant dream into a real family memory.

◦ 2015 I Chose the World Over the Office

After university, I worked for a year as an economist, including work on tenders. It was a sensible career, but ten hours at a computer made me wonder whether this was really the life I wanted.

In 2015, I moved to Phuket, Thailand, to work in tourism with Coral Travel. After a season, I moved to Cyprus, trained as a croupier, and spent about a year and a half working in a casino.

Cyprus was beautiful, but the irony wasn't lost on me: I had moved somewhere sunny and still spent my working life indoors. I didn't want to spend my days watching a clock, whether at an office desk or a casino table.

DEMO



2015 · PHUKET → CYPRUS

“

I didn't want to spend my days watching a clock, whether at an office desk or a casino table.

FROM Desk → TO World

A year as an economist, a season in Phuket, a year and a half in Cyprus.

PHUKET · CORAL TRAVEL
2015
THEN CYPRUS · CROUPIER

In red, with fur at the collar.

2019

RIYADH · ALULA · DAMMAM

Saudi Arabia: A Country Opens, Then the World Closes

In 2019, Saudi Arabia opened a new chapter in international tourism. I wanted to see this rapidly changing country for myself. I worked on tourism and entertainment projects connected with Riyadh Season and Winter at Tantora in AlUla, then continued exploring.

Then came the pandemic. Borders closed and I found myself stranded in Saudi Arabia. I contacted the Russian Embassy, which helped me with accommodation and food. I also assisted with administrative tasks involving documents and visa applications for people pursuing education or business opportunities in the Kingdom.

Without realizing it, I was already doing the kind of practical cross-border work that would eventually inspire WorldZen.

During this period, a local pilot I encountered through Couchsurfing invited me to try flying in a small recreational aircraft. I went, filmed the experience, and shared it on Instagram. People immediately began asking where they could book the same adventure.

I could have passed along a phone number. Instead, I organized an event.

Twenty people came to the first gathering. I bought water, snacks, and picnic mats, and created a desert outing around the flights. What happened that day felt magical: aircraft overhead, excited guests, strangers becoming friends, and an experience that people couldn't wait to tell others about.

That was the beginning of GulfDzen.

I created a logo, launched an Instagram presence, and promoted the experiences through Facebook groups and messaging communities. Customers recommended us to friends. A local Saudi entrepreneur offered a booking website and a way to operate through his licensed business in exchange for commission on ticket sales. We added desert picnics, live cooking, barbecues, parties, and transport for groups.

A single Instagram story had become a real tourism operation.

In July 2020, the embassy announced an evacuation flight to Russia. I was expected to leave, and the temporary support I had received could not continue indefinitely. I had a way home.

> “I did not board the flight.”
>
> JULY 2020 · THE EVACUATION FLIGHT TO RUSSIA

I decided to remain in Saudi Arabia at my own risk and continue building the business. I expanded our activities, including aviation experiences around Dammam and the Arabian Gulf. Within roughly a year, I had earned enough to purchase an apartment, buy my first iPhone and a drone, and begin investing in cryptocurrency.

DEMO



Red dress, white horse, open sand.

DEMO

○ 2021 Maldives, Turkey, and the Road to Dubai

When Saudi Arabia began allowing stranded visitors to depart, I traveled to the Maldives, one of the destinations open during the pandemic. My team remained in Saudi Arabia and I continued managing the business remotely.

I spent three months learning to dive, flying my drone, and creating content above and below the water. The absence of long commutes and constant distractions gave me time to work and learn.

When my stay ended, I traveled to Dubai, hoping I would soon be able to return to Saudi Arabia. That proved difficult. I went back to Russia for the summer and continued working remotely.

In August 2021, I traveled with my mother to Ölüdeniz, Turkey, where I went paragliding. News that Saudi Arabia was reopening gave me hope, but the vaccination-entry requirements were an obstacle: I had received Sputnik V.

○ 2022 Losing Almost Everything

At around thirty, I seemed to have achieved the life I once dreamed of. I had bought property, invested in cryptocurrency and the US stock market, had some passive income, and still had my Saudi tourism business.

Then, in February 2022, everything changed.

I suffered serious investment losses, including money tied up in schemes that failed. Meanwhile, my long absence from Saudi Arabia had exposed my business to problems of trust and financial misconduct within the team. Eventually I made the painful decision to stop operating GulfDzen.

From the outside, my life still looked beautiful. Inside, I was starting again.

I became a freelancer and content creator, working on international exhibitions, conferences, and events in Dubai and Abu Dhabi. I discovered that specialized assignments could sometimes pay more than conventional full-time work while giving me greater freedom over my schedule.

I also built a wider international network. Through friends, I gained access to discounted staff-travel opportunities with airlines and continued exploring the world: Mauritius, Seychelles, Sri Lanka, Kenya, Tanzania, Lebanon, Turkey, and more.

From the outside, my life still looked beautiful. Inside, I was starting again.

DEMO

SINDALAH · NEOM

○ 2024 Saudi Arabia, the Second Time

In October 2024, I returned to Saudi Arabia, this time on a business visa to work at the opening of Sindalah, NEOM's luxury island destination.

The contrast was extraordinary. During the pandemic I had been stranded in the Kingdom, organizing small-aircraft adventures. Now I was working on a major international destination opening. Our travel and accommodation were arranged, including a camp with facilities such as a pool and yoga space.

My assignment was short and involved welcoming guests and supporting the event atmosphere. In approximately a week I earned more than $5,000. I hoped to remain involved longer, but the assignment ended.

DESTINATION	DATE	VISA	WELCOMING
Sindalah	Oct 2024	Business	Guests

DUBAI

○ 2026 The Question of Freedom

In 2026, the Year of the Fire Horse, I marked five years of life in the Emirates and invited my parents to Dubai to celebrate.

My personal life also presented a choice. I had a relationship and received a marriage proposal, but the expectations attached to that future did not align with my values. I was being asked to withdraw from social media, limit my independence, and accept a domestic role I had not chosen.

I respect women who freely choose that life. But after everything I had built, I could not give up the right to decide how to live my own.

I realized that even a powerful passport or a comfortable home means little if the person holding it cannot make her own decisions.

PLACE	YEAR	MARKED	INVITED
Dubai	Fire Horse	Five years	Parents



SOUTH AFRICA · 2026

I stayed in Africa. I learned to surf.

The Gulf events calendar was quiet at the start of Ramadan, and flights were being cancelled. She stayed.

2026

CAPE TOWN · NAMIBIA

Africa: The Holiday That Became Another Beginning

18 Feb
Flew to South Africa

23 Feb
Flight above Cape Town

28 Feb
Black Coffee, flights cancelled



A FIRST BUNGEE JUMP. ARMS OUT.

On February 18, 2026, at the beginning of Ramadan, I flew to South Africa. The Gulf events calendar was quieter, and I wanted to use the time to explore.

On February 23, Russia's Defender of the Fatherland Day, I took a small-aircraft sightseeing flight above Cape Town. On February 28, while attending a performance by Black Coffee, escalating instability in the Middle East complicated travel and led to flight cancellations.

I had previously seen Black Coffee perform at the Sindalah opening while working. This time I was there as a guest. It felt like one of those strange moments when different chapters of life suddenly meet.

I stayed in Africa. I learned to surf, went cage diving with great white sharks, swam with seals, completed my first bungee jump, and traveled to Namibia to study kitesurfing. I also volunteered in a surf-related community setting.

I returned to South Africa and attended AfrikaBurn. Its spirit of participation, art, and community left me with new ideas about what people can create together.

2026

FRIDAY, JUNE 12

Makkah: What Faith Means to Me

When I returned to Dubai, work was still limited. Then an Indian Muslim acquaintance who had once joined my aviation events in Saudi Arabia offered to help me make a pilgrimage. He supported the organization of my journey.

On Friday, June 12, 2026 — Russia Day and the anniversary of the founding of my hometown, Izhevsk — I reached Makkah.

I had crossed oceans and visited spectacular destinations, but this journey was different. It was about gratitude, humility, and the people who had helped me when I needed it most.

For me, Islam has never been defined by clothing, food, or drink. It is not simply about outward appearances or restrictions. It is about supporting people, especially in their hardest moments, and helping others from a pure heart, with good intentions and without expecting anything in return. Faith, to me, is measured by compassion and the good we bring into the lives of others.

After my pilgrimage, I made another deeply personal decision: I got a tattoo on my neck as a symbol of freedom. For me, it was never simply about appearance. It became a reminder that my life belongs to me, that faith is something I carry in my heart, and that true freedom begins within. I had traveled across continents searching for opportunities, experiences, and meaning. But perhaps the most important freedom I discovered was the freedom to be myself.



THE GRAND MOSQUE, MAKKAH.

> “Faith, to me, is measured by compassion and the good we bring into the lives of others.”

DEMO

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FORTIORA
Voyage

The trip changes. The desk has already moved.

AI travel-desk agents for companies. They plan the itinerary, rebook when a flight falls through, remind travellers about visas and documents while there is still time to act, and capture the expense while the receipt is still in hand.

DEMO

01 **Itinerary planning**

Flights, hotels and ground transport assembled against your travel policy and sent to the traveller as one plan.

02 **Rebooking on disruption**

A cancellation or a missed connection starts a rebooking run straight away, with options laid out for the traveller to approve.

03 **Visa and document reminders**

Entry rules, passport validity and permits checked against each trip, with reminders sent while there is time to do something about them.

04 **Expense capture**

Receipts photographed or forwarded, read, categorised and filed against the trip they belong to.

VOYAGE · TRAVEL DESK

Agent online

DESK

- Trips
- Disruptions
- Documents
- Expenses
- Policy
- Run log

TRIP · TRAVELLER 01

DXB → JNB → WDH

Mon 08:40	Flight DXB → JNB · seat held
Mon 16:10	Car to hotel · confirmed
Wed 09:00	Client meeting · calendar synced
Thu 07:15	Flight JNB → WDH

DISRUPTION · THU 07:15 CANCELLED

Rebooking run started

- A Thu 11:05 · direct
- B Thu 14:30 · via CPT
- C Fri 07:15 · hotel extended

AWAITING TRAVELLER APPROVAL

DOCUMENTS

- Passport · validity checked
- Entry visa · reminder sent
- Insurance letter · attached

EXPENSES

Taxi receipt	CAPTURED
Hotel folio	FILED TO TRIP
Meal receipt	CATEGORISED

```
agent  itinerary built against policy
agent  cancellation detected · 3 options found
agent  visa reminder sent to traveller
agent  receipt read · filed to trip
agent  hotel night added · policy check passed
agent  calendar updated · meeting kept
agent  passport expiry checked against return date
desk   traveller approved option A
```

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THE NEON BRAID, AND A CITY AT NIGHT.

CHONGQING · UDMURTIA

◦ 2026 China, a Neon Braid, and the Return Home

After the pilgrimage, another Muslim friend gave me the opportunity to visit China. In Chongqing, I attended a major entertainment and networking activity and, on July 14, attracted attention with a dramatic illuminated neon braid.

I have always loved creativity and style. To me, self-expression is another form of freedom.

Then I returned to Russia to visit my family and look after my health, as I often do in summer. This time I experienced air-raid alerts and drone-related security warnings at home. Transport disruptions and the need to consider safety made me think about the people trying to find stability for themselves and their families.

◦ 2026 WorldZen: From Izhevsk to a Company Without Borders

That idea became WorldZen. The name brings together “World” and “Zen”: global possibilities and inner peace. To me, it means the freedom to explore the world, choose where you belong and feel at home within yourself, wherever life takes you.

I wanted to help people navigate visas, relocation, and international travel with less stress, wasted time, and unnecessary expense. Some clients needed a holiday. Others wanted to move for work, establish residency, or start a new chapter. Others wanted to discover Russia.

I registered my entrepreneurial activity in Russky Vozhoy, Udmurtia, the village I moved to after returning from Saudi Arabia. I wanted to build an international business from Udmurtia, where my story began. Potential regional tax incentives for qualifying new entrepreneurs were another consideration, subject to the applicable rules.

Within months, I was helping travelers, people preparing for relocation, and clients considering new countries. I also began developing a broader technological vision: a digital platform that could help people understand mobility pathways, organize documentation, and make better-informed decisions.

I wasn't beginning from zero. I was beginning with eighteen years of experience.

DEMO

WorldZen
PEOPLE. REAL OPPORTUNITIES. BEYOND BORDERS.

WHAT THE PHOTOGRAPHS LEAVE OUT

People sometimes see my photographs — beaches, airplanes, fashion, Dubai — and assume someone wealthy must be financing the lifestyle. I know those stereotypes. I have heard them directed at me.

What photographs do not show are the long working hours, the lost investments, the risks, the setbacks, and the personal work behind my health, appearance, knowledge, and independence.



DEMO

The Legacy I Dream of Leaving

One day, I want to establish a charitable foundation for women who have survived abuse — women who need safety, practical support, dignity, and the opportunity to rebuild independent lives. I want them to know that their past does not have to determine their future.

I also dream of building a mosque in the Middle East. Islam and the kindness of people I met along the way have supported me through some of the hardest chapters of my life. I want this mosque to be an enduring expression of gratitude, faith, and service to others — not a monument to personal success.

I dream of creating BerkutZen, my own international airline, with affordable flights that connect countries and people — including direct international routes from Izhevsk, the city where I was born. I want children from places like mine to grow up knowing that the world is within their reach, not reserved for those born in wealthy capitals.

And I want to create the WorldZen mobile visa and relocation application: a practical digital tool that helps people discover suitable visa pathways, prepare documents, understand requirements, and reduce the stress, time, and financial resources consumed by international mobility. I want accessible products that give people more freedom to choose where they live, work, and build their futures.

If I could speak to the little girl from Udmurtia who believed in miracles, I would tell her this: you will cross oceans, lose things you thought were secure, trust the wrong people, meet strangers who become friends, and begin again more than once.

I want to be remembered as a little girl from Izhevsk who believed in miracles, found the courage to make one happen, and then helped others believe that the impossible is possible.



DEMO

Freedom begins with an idea in your mind.

WORLDZEN — EXPLORE. RELOCATE. BELONG

01 **A foundation** for women who have survived abuse

02 **A mosque** in the Middle East

03 **BerkutZen**, an airline with routes from Izhevsk

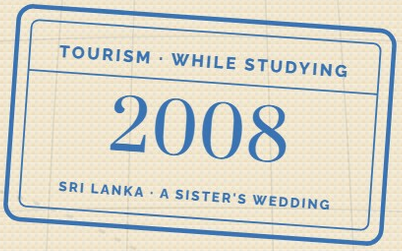
04 **The WorldZen app** for visas and relocation

1990 to 2026, in ink.

Every date and place here is from her essay. Where she gave only a year, the stamp gives only a year.



Born in the final years of the Soviet Union.



Package holidays, booking systems, family passports.



A season in Thailand, about a year and a half in Cyprus.



Winter at Tantora. Then the borders closed.



She stayed at her own risk and kept building.



Three months of diving, then paragliding in Turkey.





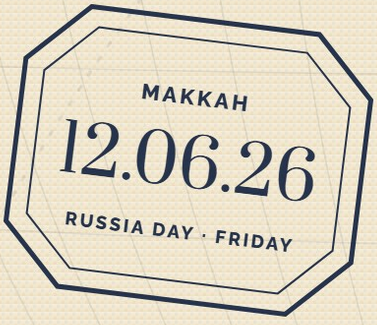
Investment losses. GulfDzen closed. Freelance in Dubai and Abu Dhabi.



The opening of the island, a week of work.



Surf, sharks, seals, a first bungee jump.



The anniversary of the founding of Izhevsk.



An entertainment and networking night.



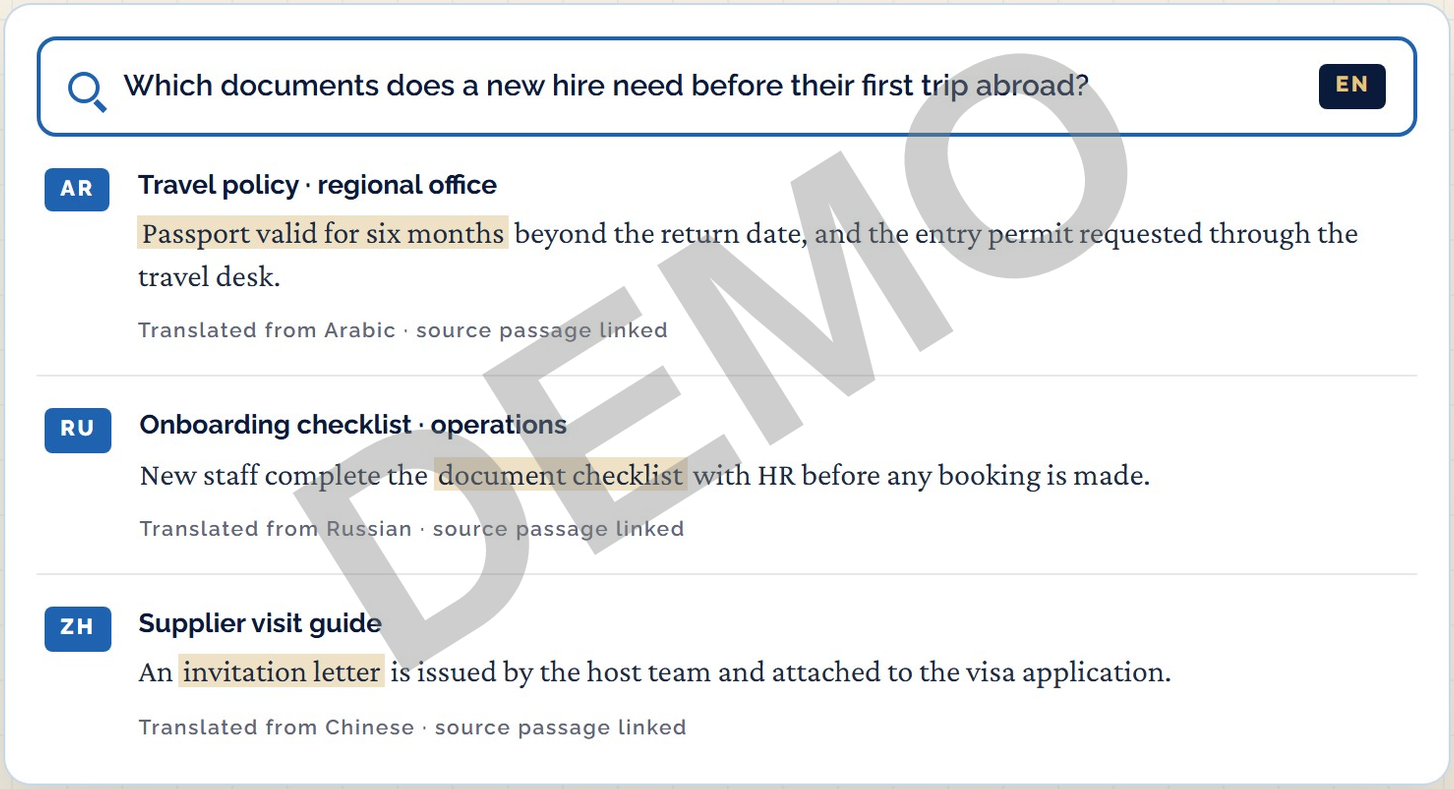
An international business, registered in Udmurtia.

DEMO

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Atlas

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One question, every language your documents are written in.

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Every answer points to the passage it came from.

PERMISSION-AWARE
People see only what they are already allowed to open.

CONNECTED
Drives, wikis, tickets and shared folders, searched together.

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PASSENGER
You

DESTINATION
The next edition

GATE
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CLASS
Leaders

01 Nominate. Tell the desk who, and why this year.

02 Sit for the interview. Written or spoken, answered in full.

03 Read it in print and on the page, with your photographs whole.

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YOUR OWN WORDS

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THE RECORD
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DATES AND PLACES KEPT

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